

CHAPTER 15: 100-BAGGERS

DISTILLED: ESSENTIAL

PRINCIPLES

LET'S BRING THIS BACK TO WHERE IT BEGAN, WITH Charles Akre, whose speech "An Investor's Odyssey" set this Phelpsian quest in motion. (See chapter 1.) Akre has a couple of 100-baggers under his belt, and a lifetime of investing has taught him the key principle behind making 100 times your money.

While this book was in its final stages, I met Akre in his office, which is far away from the frenetic pace of Wall Street.

I drove down along the western edge of the Washington beltway.

Then I headed west, deeper into Virginia. The urban landscape gave way to green fields and woods. I drove past wineries and horse farms and fieldstone fences, and past little towns with antiques shops and historic mills and churches.

Eventually, I came to Middleburg, a picturesque little town of about 600 people. Then, down a quiet side street, I found a nicely refurbished building that used to be a tavern but was now an office.

Here is where Charles T. Akre Jr. ("Chuck") has his HQ. It has a calm and comfortable feel to it, with bookshelves full of books and horsethemed art on the wall. I felt as if I was in someone's home.

Akre, 72, has been in the securities business since 1968. He's one of the great investors of our time. I have a bound volume of his letters to partners from 1993 to 2013, titled *The Power of Compounding*. A dollar invested with Akre turned into nearly \$20, compared with just \$5.59 for the S&P 500.

As I noted, it was a speech Akre gave in 2011 that introduced me to